

John Escobedo

Senior QA Test Lead | UAT & Test Strategy | Healthcare & Government Systems

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(512) 299-3269

Austin, Texas

Summary: Quality assurance professional with 18+ years of manual testing expertise across healthcare, government, e-commerce, and enterprise systems. Career includes 5+ years of .NET and Java platform testing for VA healthcare applications and home loan processing systems, with hands-on API testing using SOAP and REST protocols via Postman. Daily JIRA and Confluence user with JIRA administration experience including workflow design, project configuration, and dashboard creation. Proven track record of writing and executing comprehensive test strategies spanning UAT, regression, integration, functional, end-to-end, API, 508 compliance, and HIPAA compliance testing. Strong analytical thinker and trilingual communicator (English, Spanish, ASL) who establishes QA processes from zero and bridges technical and business stakeholders to deliver quality outcomes.

Skills

Test Strategies: UAT, Regression, Agile, Functional, Integration, Smoke, Sanity, Exploratory, Black Box, System, Usability, End-to-end, API, Acceptance, 508 Compliance, HIPAA Compliance, Cross-browser, Cross-platform, Mobile, Desktop, Web Application, Release Validation, Data Integrity, Compatibility, Verification, Validation Testing

Manual Testing & QA Process: Manual Testing, Test Planning, Test Case Design, Bug Reporting, Test Strategy Writing, QA Process Implementation

API Testing: SOAP API Testing, REST API Testing, Postman, Chrome Developer Tools

Test Management & Documentation: JIRA/Xray, JIRA Administration, Confluence, TestRail, SOP Development, Risk Management

Platform Testing: .NET Platform Testing, Java Platform Testing, Web Applications, Mobile (iOS/Android), Desktop (PC/Mac/Linux), Cross-browser/Cross-platform

Business Analysis: Requirements Elicitation, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Process Mapping & Documentation, Gap Analysis

Leadership & Process: QA Process Implementation, Team Leadership, Agile/Scrum, SDLC

AI & Prompt Engineering: Prompt Engineering & Optimization, AI Red Teaming, LLM Output Validation & QA, AI Pair Programming

Accessibility & Inclusive Design: 508 Compliance Testing, WCAG Awareness, Assistive Technology Familiarity, American Sign Language

Tools & Technologies: GitHub, SQL/JQL, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Command Line Interfaces, Postman

Industry Expertise: Healthcare & Telehealth, Government & Veterans Affairs, E-commerce, Gaming & Entertainment

Office Suites: JIRA Confluence, Office 365, Google Workspace, Adobe Creative Suite

Professional Experience

Software Tester

Sharpee.net | Austin, TX (Remote)

March 2026 to Present

Performing manual exploratory and functional testing of new web-based software applications, identifying defects and submitting detailed bug reports to improve product quality.

- Executing manual exploratory and functional testing of web applications, identifying and documenting defects with clear reproduction steps and expected vs. actual behavior.
- Submitting detailed bug reports covering UI, functional, and cross-browser issues, enabling developers to quickly isolate and resolve problems.

- Testing across multiple browsers and platforms to ensure consistent user experience and identify cross-platform compatibility issues.
- Validating new feature implementations against design specifications and expected behavior, catching regressions before release.

Robot Tele-Operator

Apptronik (via Insight Global) | Austin, TX

July 2025 to September 2025

Served as communication bridge between operations and engineering for Apptronik's humanoid robot development, translating observed behaviors into actionable documentation and establishing process standards in a fast-paced, ambiguous environment.

- Translated observed robot behaviors into clear, actionable bug reports that accelerated issue resolution for engineering teams.
- Authored startup, shutdown, and emergency shutdown procedures for 2 robot models where none existed, reducing new tester ramp-up time by approximately 50% and establishing reference materials adopted as team standard.
- Bridged operations and engineering communication, keeping both teams aligned on priorities and findings.
- Reached full productivity in a novel role with minimal onboarding, independently navigating a complex robotics domain.
- Reduced physical testing environment setup time by 75% by standardizing the preparation pattern, ensuring consistent and repeatable conditions for data collection.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester | Scrum Master

GeekSI | Tallahassee, FL

March 2019 to June 2025

Senior contractor providing requirements analysis, UAT leadership, and quality assurance across multiple mission-critical VA healthcare projects. Subject matter expert for complex clinical modules, facilitating knowledge transfer and driving process standardization across distributed teams.

- Became the go-to SME for the Traumatic Brain Injury module, running knowledge transfer sessions that enabled cross-functional teams to navigate complex healthcare domain requirements.
- Championed the transition from Waterfall to Agile, introducing release discipline and predictable delivery cycles to teams accustomed to ad-hoc shipping practices.
- Advocated for and implemented code freeze and release candidate practices, shifting teams from reactive firefighting to proactive quality control.
- Used JIRA and Confluence daily to manage test cases, track defects, document requirements, and coordinate with distributed teams across multiple VA projects.
- Performed SOAP API testing for VA home loan processing systems, populating and validating service queries to ensure data integrity across .NET-based applications.
- Conducted REST API testing using Postman to verify backend services and data contracts for Java-based healthcare modules.
- Executed manual test strategies across .NET and Java platforms including functional, regression, integration, and end-to-end testing for clinical healthcare applications.
- Developed and maintained comprehensive test strategies encompassing UAT, regression, smoke, sanity, and 508 compliance testing for VA healthcare systems.
- Drove standardization of testing practices and documentation across multiple VA projects, building consensus among distributed teams and reducing onboarding time for new analysts.
- Advocated for accessibility as a core quality metric, leading 508 compliance initiatives and educating team members on inclusive design requirements.
- Collaborated with automation engineers to validate Cucumber/Selenium scripts, catching requirement-execution gaps before automated tests went into rotation.

- Built requirements traceability documentation that mapped every business need to test coverage across web, mainframe, and mobile platforms.

Senior QA Test Lead | Quality Assurance Tester

EverlyWell | Austin, TX

June 2018 to October 2018

Partnered with engineering and product leadership to establish quality processes and design cross-team workflows for a health tech startup's secure patient portal during a period of rapid organizational change.

- Served as JIRA administrator, designing a unified JIRA workflow with custom issue types, screens, and transitions that facilitated smoother cross-team collaboration and visibility into release status.
- Managed JIRA project configurations including permission schemes, notification settings, and dashboard creation to support QA and development workflows.
- Assessed release risks and communicated go/no-go recommendations to product and engineering leadership, balancing speed-to-market with quality.
- Defined initial QA process and release validation criteria for a team shipping without formal quality gates, establishing standards that brought predictability to a fast-moving startup environment.
- Mentored team members on effective documentation practices and quality standards to foster a culture of quality across the organization.
- Validated releases across all major browsers and mobile devices, catching requirement gaps before production deployment.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

YouScience | Austin, TX

July 2017 to June 2018

As the sole QA resource, built comprehensive quality processes and test infrastructure for the company's flagship education assessment platform, earning credibility with development and product teams.

- Introduced foundational quality practices—version control discipline, release candidates, and structured validation—to a team shipping without formal QA process, establishing credibility that integrated quality as a respected part of the SDLC.
- Created end-to-end test documentation spanning procedures, requirements traceability, and verification standards.
- Improved developer-QA communication by introducing standardized user story and acceptance criteria templates, reducing ambiguity and accelerating delivery.
- Created and maintained product documentation to support new feature releases and ensure consistent understanding of requirements.
- Owned end-to-end validation for the flagship web application, gating every release across browsers and mobile platforms.

QA Tester | QA Analyst

Luna Data Solutions | Austin, TX

May 2015 to May 2017

Contracted as QA Analyst for RetailMeNot, coordinating cross-team efforts for high-visibility e-commerce feature launches and aligning testing priorities with business objectives.

- Coordinated QA efforts across multiple teams for the gift card feature launch supporting a \$22M acquisition, aligning testing priorities with business objectives and leadership expectations.
- Built custom JavaScript tools to validate site-wide analytics implementation and data integrity, ensuring business requirements were accurately captured.
- Created standardized test documentation and data suites that eliminated inconsistencies across testing environments.
- Responded to live production issues under pressure, triaging problems and communicating status updates to leadership during critical outages.

- Partnered with developers to enhance internal tooling, ensure a CI/CD workflow, and contribute improvements that increased team efficiency.

QA Test Lead | QA Analyst

Communication Services for the Deaf | Austin, TX
May 2013 to January 2015

Developed inaugural QA process for an accessibility-focused video interpreting platform, immersing in user community to ensure product truly met the needs of Deaf and hard-of-hearing users.

- Invested in learning American Sign Language and Deaf cultural norms to understand user needs and ensure the product truly served its community—a user research approach that informed requirements validation.
- Established the company's first-ever quality assurance function from zero, defining test procedures and quality benchmarks that enabled the team to identify non-functional code blocking product delivery.
- Managed full validation lifecycle including creating test plans, executing test runs, and reporting results to stakeholders for both web and mobile platforms.
- Solved cross-platform testing limitations by implementing a VirtualBox-based solution, expanding test coverage to previously unreachable environments.

Lead QA Tester | Quality Assurance Tester

DocbookMD | Austin, TX
July 2012 to April 2013

Founded and scaled the QA function for a HIPAA-compliant healthcare messaging app, ensuring regulatory requirements were met while building the team and processes where none existed.

- Analyzed and documented HIPAA compliance requirements, ensuring application met strict regulatory standards for secure transmission of patient health information.
- Grew the QA department from a solo operation to a full team, hiring, onboarding, and mentoring new analysts while codifying repeatable quality processes.
- Developed initial test strategy and comprehensive documentation to ensure software met business and regulatory requirements before release.
- Executed functional, regression, and HIPAA compliance validation across all supported mobile devices, including devising creative testing methods (simulating network outages via elevator rides) to catch edge cases missed by standard approaches.

Additional Experience

QA Test Lead QA Tester	Luna Data Solutions / Heatwave Interactive	(2011-2012)
Game Master Customer Experience & Trust Specialist	Blizzard Entertainment	(2010-2011)
QA Analyst Support Tools Developer Community Operations	Linden Lab	(2007-2010)
QA Tester	Super Happy Fun Fun	(2006-2007)
QA Test Lead, QA Game Tester	Aspyr Media	(2006)

Education

Austin Community College

American Sign Language
2015 - 2017

ASL School

American Sign Language
2008 - 2012

Vista College - Berkeley, CA

Video Editing and Life Drawing
2001 - 2002

A.I. of Houston - Houston, TX

Fine Art, Typography, Layout, 3D Max
1995 - 1996

San Jacinto College - Pasadena, TX

Computer Science, Fine Art
1993 - 1995

Online version: <https://johnesco.github.io/resume>